Album Selection Service: Monthly Running Costs

Estimate for 20, 50, 100 and 150 clients a month · VPS on a 6-month term · prepared 21 October 2026

1. Recommended server

GoDaddy VPS, 2 vCPU / 4 GB RAM / 100 GB NVMe, paid every 6 months. Photos never pass through this server: photographers upload straight to Backblaze B2, and customers view them through Cloudflare. The server only runs the website, logins and the photo-selection lists, so 2 vCPU / 4 GB stays fast up to 150 clients a month, with room to grow. The 1 vCPU plan would work for 20 clients, but one busy evening or background job could slow the site, so it is not recommended.

Plan	Price / month	With 18% GST	Per 6 months (upfront)
2 vCPU / 4 GB RAM / 100 GB (recommended)	₹2,249	₹2,654	₹15,924
1 vCPU / 2 GB RAM / 40 GB (not recommended)	₹1,049	₹1,238	₹7,428

The ₹1,299 offer in GoDaddy's ad is only for a 3-year term. For a 6-month term this sheet uses the normal list price of ₹2,249 a month. Confirm the exact 6-month price with GoDaddy before paying.

2. Monthly charges

Item	20 clients	50 clients	100 clients	150 clients
VPS server (2 vCPU / 4 GB, incl. GST)	₹2,654	₹2,654	₹2,654	₹2,654
Backblaze B2 photo storage	₹199	₹498	₹997	₹1,495
Backblaze B2 API calls (allowance)	₹50	₹50	₹50	₹50
Cloudflare (Free plan: delivery, SSL, protection)	₹0	₹0	₹0	₹0
WhatsApp messages (₹30 per client)	₹600	₹1,500	₹3,000	₹4,500
Domain name (.in, yearly cost ÷ 12)	₹100	₹100	₹100	₹100
Total per month	**₹3,603**	**₹4,802**	**₹6,801**	**₹8,799**
Cost per client	₹180	₹96	₹68	₹59
Photos stored at any time	315 GB	788 GB	1.57 TB	2.36 TB

3. Six-month totals

Item	20 clients	50 clients	100 clients	150 clients
VPS, paid upfront for 6 months	₹15,924	₹15,924	₹15,924	₹15,924
Storage, WhatsApp and domain (paid monthly)	₹5,694	₹12,888	₹24,882	₹36,870
Total for 6 months	**₹21,618**	**₹28,812**	**₹40,806**	**₹52,794**

4. How the numbers were worked out

- **Photos per client:** 10 GB of originals plus about 0.5 GB of small preview copies used on the selection page.
- **How long photos are kept:** 45 days from upload (selection window plus time to design the album), then deleted automatically. Storage therefore holds about 1.5 months of clients at any time.
- **Backblaze B2:** US$6.95 per TB per month, converted at ₹88 per dollar plus a 3.5% card exchange fee. Uploading is free, and viewing photos through Cloudflare is free.
- **Cloudflare:** the Free plan is free permanently, not a trial. It connects B2 to the website, keeps copies of the photos close to customers so pages load fast, and provides free SSL and attack protection.
- **WhatsApp:** a flat ₹30 per client, as agreed.
- **GST:** 18% is added to the VPS. Backblaze bills in US dollars; if the business is GST-registered, 18% GST may also apply to it under reverse charge.

5. To confirm before quoting

- GoDaddy's exact 6-month price for the 2 vCPU / 4 GB plan (assumed ₹2,249 a month before GST).
- Backblaze B2's current price per TB on backblaze.com.
- How long photographers want photos kept. Keeping them 3 months instead of 45 days doubles the storage line.

All figures are estimates based on typical photo sizes and published prices. The server has not been load-tested yet; a test simulating 50–100 people selecting photos at once should be run once the VPS is set up.